

Baking Sourdough Bread

Sourdough is leavened by a starter, a culture of wild yeast and lactic acid bacteria kept alive with regular feedings of flour and water. Feed the starter the night before baking so that it is active and bubbly. Mix flour, water and salt with a portion of the starter, then let the dough rest. Instead of kneading, stretch and fold the dough every thirty minutes for the first two hours to build gluten strength.

Shape the dough into a tight ball, place it in a floured basket and proof it in the fridge overnight; the cold slows fermentation and deepens the flavour. Bake in a preheated Dutch oven at a high temperature, removing the lid halfway through so the crust can darken and crisp.